



SONIQUE
DRUMS®

BORN IN COLORADO

SUMMER 2026/27
Product Catalog

Percussion
Accessories

Solid Shell
Snare Drums

Artist Spotlight:
Jazz Waveologist -
Wayne Matthews Jr.



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Isabella "splendi" Croce | Independent (photo: Mae Krell)

HOW IT STARTED

Sans the luxury to rest safely on decades or even centuries of existence as a company in the drum and percussion industry, we knew we couldn't continue the status quo; no one would take us seriously, nor should they. Jeannie and I have spent nearly our entire professional and personal lives working to avoid becoming the lowest common denominator and as we entered into the percussion industry in 2020, this would be no different.

In deciding to manufacture as much hardware as we could, it became clear why most manufacturers land on various design decisions. The swivel nut, gaskets, shell construction, and even the tension rod design are by-products of a cost-effective manufacturing approach. While not evil itself, it seemed (to us) that the percussion industry was in a catatonic state where production costs are driving decisions for drum and accessory construction, not the artists experience.

In 2020, we began the journey of designing our own lugs and getting rid of the swivel nut. We machined our own tension rods that don't have excessively rounded off heads. We created the industry first socket drum key that allows for 3x faster engagement. And after 1.5 years of R&D, we created the industry-first & continuously adjustable snare throw off, the NATO-1, that gives artists full control over the snare with only one adjustment. These and upcoming products highlight our primary mission to create reliable and quality drums and percussion accessories for all.

OUR PHILOSOPHY

Be Customer Obsessed: Whether you're just starting out in the world of drumming, playing professionally, or enjoying being a hobbyist, we are obsessed with being a part of your journey. Your success is our success however you define it and we want to do our absolute best to ensure you have a good customer experience.

Insist On The Highest Standards: It's not hard to make a good drum but it's much harder to make a great one. We don't offer drums with die-cast hardware, plywood-shells, or veneers over plywood. Our drums are made equally, using the same high standard. Only the wood species or hardware alloy affects the price. That's why we say every drum is a flagship; using only the best materials, every time.

Innovate & Simplify: Doing the same thing because it's "always been done that way" is not why we're in business. We always want to ask why, and ask the question, "is there a better way?". We don't have as much to lose like the big box drum companies and we don't mind being different, unique, or disruptive at the expense of conformity.

BEAD KING BEADED SNARE ADAPTER

The Bead King™ expands compatibility from the original BS-1 to other throw offs that also can use a 7/8" hole spacing. Its generous arch cutout accommodates a wide variety of bead profiles and longer mounting slots to accommodate variations in hole spacing as it relates to the location of the bead. It's easy to install and we include a complete hardware kit to get you upgraded and ready to play again in minutes. The Bead King™ is an all aluminum, CNC machined adapter that is designed to retro-fit with many popular, modern throw offs using the 7/8" hole spacing to beaded snares that typically use the traditional Ludwig hole spacing range of 2.00" to 2 11/16".

The Bead King™ Beaded Snare adapter is made from machined aluminum, weighs less than 1 ounce, and matches the curvature of the snare drum for a snug fit without adding gaskets. The introduction of the BS-1 now gives drummers the ability to retro-fit over 20 popular throw offs to their favorite beaded snare.

- Machined, hard anodized aluminum
- Weighs less than 1 ounce
- No gaskets required, snug fit to the shell
- Compatible with NATO, Dunnett, Trick, DW MAG, SJC Quick throw, and other popular throw offs.
- Hardware kit included



THE ORIGINAL NATO-1 THROW OFF

The ultra-light, compact, silent, uncomplicated, and continuously adjustable NATO-1 throw off is the only continuously adjustable throw-off available today. The NATO-1 allows you, the artist to easily adjust snare wire position and tension with a single movement of the handle; just turn and play. With no steps or locks to limit how your snare sounds, you now have infinite points of adjustment across the entire range of motion of the snare wires; unlocking the full potential of your snare. Available with a clear, red, or black anodized aluminum body with aluminum trim. Now available with an optional short handle that is sold separately (pictured). (butt plate optional).



NATO-1R

THE NATO-1 XL THROW OFF

Enjoyed and trusted by drummers on tour, in the studio, and in the club, the NATO-1 XL features an extended mounting bar compared to the original NATO-1. This allows it to retrofit to over 50 throw off models (and counting) from vintage to modern! With a dozen hole spacings from 3/8" to 1 11/16" to use, and an updated aesthetic to match the curvature of the drum shell, the performance, fit, and finish of the NATO-1 XL is unmatched in the industry. Available in clear, black, or red anodized body with either aluminum or brass trim. Now available with an optional short handle that is sold separately (pictured). (butt plate optional).



POLY PRO FAMILY of SNARE WIRE STRAPS

Designed for use with strap-mounted snare wires, the Sonique Poly Pro snare wire straps are made from 100% polyester grosgrain ribbon. Our snare wire straps will not stretch, shrink, or fade like other straps made from nylon or cord. Whether you're playing a gig outdoors in the rain, spill your favorite beer over your snare between sets, or just like to crank up the tension, the 100% polyester Poly Pro strap has your back. Sold in sets of two.

- Low stretch (no memory) material vs nylon for consistent tension, all the time
- Slight ribbing for added grip
- Each end is hot knife cut to prevent fraying
- Each strap is 9.5" long (24.1cm) & 9/16" wide (1.43cm)
- Industry standard 0.5mm thin



STEAM-BENT SNARE DRUMS

LEGACY CUSTOM
SERIES
SSD-14-RW
(E. Indian Rosewood)



STUDIO SERIES
SSD-14-STU-CH
(N. American Cherry)



Using quality steam-bent shells, a versatile snare bed, and thoughtful construction techniques, we believe our snares are best-in-class. Sonique snares have already been used to record several albums both released & upcoming, and used on tour by some of the best drummers around. Each snare is built one at a time and includes a complimentary Gator hard case. Both Legacy and Studio Series snare drums are constructed with solid brass hardware and cast bronze hoops. Stage Series snares are constructed with anodized aluminum hardware and cast aluminum hoops. Wood species for the Stage Series are limited to Ash, Cherry, and Maple.



STAGE SERIES
SSD-14-STA-AS
(N. American Ash)



STUDIO SERIES

SSD-14-STU-RW
(E. Indian Rosewood)



LEGACY SERIES SNARE DRUMS

Original, bold, unapologetic, and uniquely us, the Legacy Custom line of snare drums offer custom details while maintaining a level of drum construction never seen before in the industry. By using a moderate thickness steam-bent shell, naturally resonating alloys, we enable the snare drum to give us all of the possible resonating potential and tone that it has to give.

Learning from history and settled science, instead of repeating it only to learn the same thing again, is one of the foundations of our design methodologies. From our unique snare bed, tension rod design, removal of all gaskets, using a unibody lug, and our choice of shell thickness all contribute to what we believe is the highest quality snare drum available and without attaching a stratospheric price tag to it.

We say every drum is a flagship because we don't change the underlying design of the drum or its components. Only the wood species affects the price of your snare drum. Every drum is made the same way, every time, using only the best materials and methods.



LEGACY SERIES SNARES



AVAILABLE IN:

ASH
BEECH
BIRCH
CHERRY
E. BLACK WALNUT
E. INDIAN ROSEWOOD
HICKORY
MAPLE (BIRDSEYE)
MAPLE (TIGER)
PACIFIC WALNUT

- Available in 14" Diameter
- Depths from 4.5" to 7"
- Two Hoop Style Options
- Includes Gator Hard Case



STAGE & STUDIO SERIES SNARES

Stage & Studio Series snares carry forward most of the same construction methods and materials as with the Legacy Custom Series but with an evolution in design. Borrowing from the shapes found in the NATO-1 throw off and butt plate, we designed a more cohesive lug to match. We also introduced a backing plate design for the lugs to minimize prying forces against the snare shell. The Stage & Studio Series snares are a natural evolution from the the last five years of research and development.

With both Stage & Studio Series snares, every piece of hardware touching the shell is CNC machined to conform to the curvature of the shell for optimum fit and finish.

We say every drum is a flagship because we don't change the underlying design of the drum or its components. Only the wood species affects the price of your snare drum. Every drum is made the same way, every time, using only the best materials and methods.



STAGE & STUDIO SNARE DRUMS



AVAILABLE IN:

ASH
BEECH
BIRCH
CHERRY
E. BLACK WALNUT
E. INDIAN ROSEWOOD
HICKORY
MAPLE (BIRDSEYE)
MAPLE (TIGER)
PACIFIC WALNUT
RED GUM

- Available in 14" Diameter
- Depths from 4.5" to 7"
- Two Hoop Style Options
- Includes Gator Hard Case

* Stage Series snares are only available in Ash, Cherry, or Maple.

UPCOMING ACCESSORIES



KitFx 20G

The **KitFx 20G** is our 20 gram (0.7 oz) set of bass drum beater weights. Designed to fit standard bass drum beaters both vintage and modern. Our advancement in beater weight design uses a clamping action that secures the weight evenly around the entire beater shaft instead of a single point of failure of a thumb screw. Coming soon.

The birth of the Bead King™ has evolved to now include a solid brass version and a version without the arch cutout, made for non-beaded snares to retrofit for longer throw off hole spacings up to 2 11/16". Both special order only). In addition, we've introduced a standoff bracket specifically designed to retrofit your favorite throw off to snares less than 4.5" in depth. The standoff bracket elevates your throw off beyond the profile of the hoop to keep it clear of any obstruction. All are compatible with any throw off that can use a 7/8" hole spacing.



ASS MOVIN'
MAD AS HELL
BLACK AND TAN
BITCHSHEMIAN RHAPSODY
YOU'LL ONLY LIKE ME WHEN I'M DEAD
I LOVE THAT FOR YOU
IT'S A HIT
WHATCHAGONNADO?
LOVESICK
BI SEXY

RIA RUA - SCAPEGOAT

RIA RUA - SCAPEGOAT



EVANSTM

DRUMHEADS

USED EXCLUSIVELY BY SONIQUE DRUMS

Inside The Mind of: Wayne Matthews Jr.



We got the call from Wayne on a chilly night in Denver. "Hey man, I just flew in to play a gig with Braxton Cook at Dazzle. Can you come?". The answer was an immediate "yes!". As I walked into the club, it's packed and buzzing. I find an open table and Wayne comes out from the green room to sit down and chat for a bit before the show.

SD:

You started out your life and later, your musical adventure in New Orleans. How do you think that played a part in your current trajectory musically? Would you say that being around the New Orleans jazz scene was the heaviest influence on you early on?

WMJ:

I would say it played the whole part! First off, I owe it to my parents to Fast Tracking me into music. Because my Pops played keys and guitar, and my mom sang in church (Solid Rock, Caffin Ave COGIC, later Powerhouse) I'd like to think my road was destined to lead to music. And having my career start in the City of New Orleans made it 10 times better.

New Orleans is a legacy based city. So you had to be from a family, a certain school, went to NOCCA or basically cosigned from a musician or



Photo: (Wayne Matthews, Jr.)

act from a previous generation in order to get real gas in your career at that time. What's so funny is most of my career was spent forging a path outside of just the Jazz lane, because to be frank, I didn't really fit anywhere or wasn't known anywhere till I stood solid on myself.

R.O.C.C. Out, Musical Expression, and CoolNasty. And each band was so different from each other, which was perfect. It allowed for people to get hip to me as a person, and creatively - to expand my thoughts in different arenas, which perfectly describes New Orleans, because it truly is a melting pot of different cultures.

SD:

Why did you decide to come to Los Angeles? How do you think that decision to leave...

New Orleans and come to L.A. has impacted your trajectory as a musician?

WMJ:

I came to L.A. with CoolNasty. I wasn't ready to leave yet, for everyone that knew me at the time. But I was willing to take the chance on us, and the opportunity of our success in that musical arena, because we didn't have anything tying us down to the City, like children and marriages. But to be real, we felt like we had done everything we could do at that particular time, and were in pursuit of something greater.

Los Angeles has dialed me back a bit creatively. Some would call it refining, but in terms of I'm not having to output as much bandwidth behind the drums. To go from performing regularly in three

bands at different times, to just one and the rest is freelance, I played less notes. Workflow! I went from determining the sound of three arenas to now "I need you to play this record note for note." In every drummer's progression, we all get to that point eventually. All of the cats that came before us reference that, because of age and wisdom. Not every artist needs that expressive style. BUT if they ask, give it to them.

SD:

Does it feel like every performance in L.A. is an interview? Tell us how you deal with the pressure of constantly being under the watchful eye of other musicians and other influential players in the music industry.

WMJ:

It doesn't bother me as much as it used to. When you insert yourself into a bigger market, it's natural to want to be in good graces with the bigger names of our industry. I was there, but I lost the confidence in my sound as a result. For the sake of gaining more work, I was just playing more keys at jams than anything. There are soooo many drummers around, and I took it to heart when I wasn't receiving "the cosign." Then after a while I

said "screw it." Enhance it if you need to.

I needed to believe in what God gave me. Makes no sense to get a bunch of cosigns that ultimately will not move the needle for me, unless they deem me worthy. So that's how I dealt with the pressure – the realization that they bleed blood just like me. We exist on the same plain. Everything started to click for me after that moment.

SD:

You sometimes play many roles as a musician. You're known as a drummer I think in most circles but you also are a music director, keyboard player, producer, and arranger. Man it feels like you do it all. Were you a keyboard player first or a drummer? How do you think either of those instruments influences the other?

Photo: 2026 (Instagram @thecenturyroom)



WMJ:

I was a drummer first. I played around with whatever newest keyboard Pop had at the time, till I went to Xavier University of Louisiana. That's when the key journey became serious for me. Diving into Piano helped me on the arranging side. Cause I had ideas, and I was challenged by my bandmate at the time, Myla Bocage to play them. Little did she know, that moment birthed a monster. The more I got into keys, the better arranger I became. Then as I hopped back on drums to complete the arrangement, my decision making on drums became much sweeter.

Myla also introduced me to Picasseaux, who spearheaded a production group that I joined, called House of Chords. Diving into production helped me see the bigger picture. The conversion from musical to digestible was the biggest lesson. Because my arranging had been enhancements to songs, but what are the components of the original song? How was it made? Game changer for all other instruments.

SD:

Speaking of jazz, you've played lately with a number of fantastic artists like the incredible saxophonist and singer, Braxton Cook....

We're catching up with you now at Dazzle Denver Jazz Club in Denver, Colorado with Braxton. Tell us how you got connected with him and what that experience has been like.

WMJ:

Funny story. HA! So I met Brax playing church drums for First Corinthians Bible Church. (There's a reason why I say church drums. It's a whole different beast.) They're a New York based congregation, but they were starting an L.A. branch. So he attended FCBC as he was living in NY. He moved to L.A., and that's where he saw me. But this was 3 years prior to me actually playing for him.

Paul Reinhold (@ptrbass) is really who solidified the opportunity for me. His voucher got me in the door. Because Church Drums are different from Jazz Drums. Their nuances and technique sets are different. Both equally respected. But the marriage in between the two is what Brax saw in me.

Playing for Brax is full circle. I grew up listening to his sound. His Stretch Music tenure with Chief Xian (Christian Scott) unlocked a lot of sonic inspiration for all of us. So my respect for him and his music

as a youth allows for me to be thankful for this opportunity as an adult. Plus his music allows for an amount of individuality that I was very surprised by. It's a different style of leadership that I'm grateful to have witnessed. It allows for a unique experience to the sound of his compositions, because it depends on who's playing his show at that particular time. Truly is amazing.

SD:

You have played and currently play with several very talented and successful artists/groups like Braxton Cook, Tatiana Tate, Joy Guerrilla, Black Art Distrikt, and Roman Collins. You've been with Joy Guerrilla for two years now. How do you approach each of these different artists, sounds, etc. as a musician? It seems like keeping this all together and right might be a really hard thing to juggle!

WMJ:

As a musician, each of those artists require something different. Some of those sounds carry over, which makes it easy, because I get to play me. It isn't a requirement, but overall it helps to have an outlet like Black Art Distrikt. With 97% of the gig being improv, it's world building. I have the ability to try things over there without fear

of failure, because we are all in the same position in making the composition right there. The decision only ends up being wrong if it doesn't serve the music at that particular time. To give a polar opposite experience, Joy Guerrilla is a tune based band, with each composition having multiple sections. So my sound is then tailored to their music.

SD:

You said once that being misunderstood was one of the best things that could have ever happened to you. How do you think that realization has guided you as an artist?

WMJ:

Being misunderstood allowed for me to be creatively self sufficient. In the last write up I did for CanvaRebel, it was a very fresh concept for me, but as time passed by, I realized that it was a perfect lane for me. It validated my hardships socially. It confirmed every rejection to ultimately be a good thing. My desire to be wanted in certain phases of life that brought me heartache and pain, suddenly was gone by a simple concept. Do right by YOUR gift, not shaping it to what someone else thinks of your thing. Imagine Jesus not stepping into the call God had for His life. If He let the Pharisees determine

what he was supposed to be doing. Jesus was willing to be misunderstood. That's Artistry.

SD:

In the American South, gospel music is ubiquitous. What kind of influences did gospel music have on you, past or present?

WMJ:

To be honest, Gospel music is truly universal to all regions

SD:

You have been a long-time collaborator and drummer for the incredible trumpeter, composer, and band leader, Tatiana Tate. How did you first get involved with her and what has that experience been like so far?

WMJ:

So, I met her twice. Haha. First at a Brass Roots District event, which was a 70's immersive experience, filled with extras, characters, a very off the phone ordeal. Very on brand for her. Secondly, at Black Art Distrikt's 1st unofficial Everything Raw, which is an event that the group hosts, now monthly. We really didn't lock in with each other till 2023. Cause we had both been members of the group, but we weren't always on the same bill, because the lineup changes from gig to gig. Then we got to know each other outside the group, and we've been together ever since.



What's crazy is this ties in from the earlier question about playing with so many different artists. For Tatiana Tate, it's even more of a tailor, cause she plays so many different avenues. And also she requires a certain play style that is sometimes VERY different from the way I'm accustomed to playing. Long story short, it's not easy, and sometimes the ball gets dropped. But I still gotta pick it up, and get back in the game. You owe it to yourself.

SD:

The music industry is vast but can also feel small at the same time. For example, you're already working with Tatiana but Tatiana also played on a track of Pocket Queen's EP called ...



Photo: 2025 YouTube (youtube.com/@rainerduve53)

"Introducing: Pocket Queen and The Royal Flush", which brings it full circle because you and Pocket Queen (a.k.a. Taylor Gordon) have known each other for a long time. Does it sometimes blow your mind how little the degrees of separation can be with other artists when you work within one of the epicenters of the music industry?"

WMJ:

Not at all. I've lived a great life so far of good people meeting good people. PQ and Tatle had known about each other because of their respective platforms being built up, but never got close enough in proximity until I got asked about

availability. And quiet as it's kept, all it takes is the right person to connect people together. All of the industry's greatest success stories come from link ups like this one.

SD:

Tell us what your go-to drumstick is right now? And what's your current selection of cymbals that you can't live without? Favorite heads?

WMJ:

I've been playing all of Wincent's stuff right now across the board. 7A XL's, 5A's, 55F's, 55F XL's, 5B XL's, all kinds in that stick bag. And it all is great. Durable. But nothing feels like home, like a good pair of Vic's. 5A DoubleGlazed Hand picked

when the weight is heavy and right? Chef's kiss. Right now my bag carries an array of cymbals. But the one I get asked about the most is my main ride right now, which is a 22" Cymbal and Gong Holy Grail series ride. Shoutout to Todd Bishop. He nicknamed this particular one Eloi. And I absolutely love it. Now because of rigorous travel, it did catch a crack in the bell, but I got it cut out.

SD:

Tell us your Mt. Rushmore of drummers.

WMJ:

This one is gonna be difficult. I'm sure of it. In no particular order: Marvin McQuitty, Billy Cobham, Zigaboo Modeliste, Weedie Braimah and honorable Mention to Justin Tyson.

SD:

We haven't even talked about Joy Guerilla which feels like a super funky, laid back, kind of sound which sprinkles in very creative sounds both old and new. How long have you been playing with Joy Guerilla? How did you originally get involved? What has being a part of this sound been like for you and where do you see it going?



Photo: 2024 (Josh Herwitt)

WMJ:

Man you just like that the bass player's name is Adam too. Haha! But I been with Joy Guerrilla since mid 2024. We got involved in a classic modern day Music Industry connection. Instagram. Brian Hargrove had recommended me to Adam and Mags, and they checked my page out, hit me the DM's, played the 1st gig at Gold Diggers, and we've been locked in ever since. We're actually super close.

Being a part of Joy Guerrilla is truly a joy. I have a deep love for Fusion music. Fusion is truly Top 3 spaces where I've been able to truly find and show my sound, and Joy Guerilla has done a great job in carving their own lane in the Fusion legacy. I tell Adam all

the time that they give me too many liberties. Haha. But my mentality has always been to keep their continuity of sound. The energy on the drums definitely have changed, solely because there were different drummers on the previous releases. This is also reflected in the live shows with how the tunes are played. The Bergatron session is actually a great example of that. Now the new album is going to be something special. The new music is so killer, and I can't wait for y'all to hear it.

SD:

What is your favorite venue to play in L.A. or elsewhere and which venue would you like to play in soon that you haven't played before?

WMJ:

Townhouse Venice. On the patio, and downstairs at the Del Monte Speakeasy. I have given some of the best God has given in that space. Truly my playing is so different there. So many Black Art Distrikt hits there, subbing for Sensei Greg Paul with Katalyst, Joy Guerrilla has been down there, the fresh gun Chris Powe, just to name who I've played with there. I would like to play the Baked Potato space. It's legendary to the Musician world. One of those "gotta play there one time before I hang it up" type beat. Shoutout to Glynn Dollison for that one. Haha. Every show I go to see is so amazing. So much legacy there. But to be honest, any artist that calls, it's an honor to share the gift no matter where it is. I don't take that lightly.

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